School Council Minutes Monday October 07, 2024

Attendance:

Stephanie Scott
Christine Rogalsky
Tyler Holland
Elysse Wing
Brent Ramdial
A.J. Vlcek
Lauren Mcdonald
Maite Feeny

Amy Humphries (Principal)
Farida Jamal (Vice Principal)
Karen Wolfe (Teacher)

Regrets:

Hilory Steffan

Call to order: 18:03

Approve May Minutes and October agenda: Hilory Steffen (from agenda). Approved.

Role of School Council: Presented by Farida Jamal

- Involvement of parents & guardians & wider community has positive impact on student academics and social development
- Council is an advisory body – parameters set by ministery & board
- Parents work with staff to help student learning – not a place for advocacy for one's own child, should be dealt with through teacher & administration
- Staff members of council (principal, vice principal and teachers) do not actually vote, cannot move or second other people's motions

New School Council Members: Presented by Farida Jamal

- Members should commit to attend the meetings
- Quorum should be reduced to 4-6 members this year to ensure we make quorum on a regular basis

Defining Executive Roles: Presented by Farida Jamal

- Council Chair:
    - Chair is main liason with school, chairs the meetings, ensures that minutes are taken, default spokesperson for council
    - Elected by council – must be parent(s) who are not employed by school board (so cannot be held by principal, vice principal or teacher)
    - Voting member, has same duties as any other member AND chairs, prepares for meetings, sets agenda, communicates with principal on behalf of council

    - EZ chair has to manage the e-mail list for council members, liaises with EZ parent Facebook group. Prepares WRAPSC update – chair attends WRAPSC meeting, talks about it at next school council meeting
    - Approx 10 hours/month Job can be split between two parents, eases the workload (especially for coming to meetings). Sounds like a lot but is manageable.
- Secretary: responsible for taking minutes & sharing with council & principal & finalizing them to upload
    - Keeps records of council
    - Tasks: record minutes & distribute for approval to exec. Send e-mail copies to approved minutes to larger council group. Follow-up with people who have other jobs. Available to answer e-mail from principal, vp and exec. Make sure someone else takes minutes if needed
    - 5-10 hours/month
- Treasurer: draft budget, perform bookkeeping
    - Keep track of cash balance, provide monthy report, liaise with school secretary & be up to date on money
    - 5-10 hours/month.

Motion to approve roles as described: Lauren, seconded A.J. Passed.

Motion to approve executive:

Volunteers to run as chair: Lauren willing to co-chair again, Hilory sent in a statement that she'd be willing to do so – Lauren would have to miss some meetings, but Hilory is aware of that and willing to work around it. Acclaimed

Volunteers to run as secretary: Christine. Acclaimed

Volunteers to run as treasurer: Maite. Acclaimed.

Financial Summary:

Grand total of 11 206.20 in school account.

Since the last board meeting the following expenses have come out of the account, as approved last year:

- 4712.45 for pizza expenses May 30-June 20
- Field trip money approved last year for grade 5/6 classes
- Play dough for bags at Welcome to Kindergarten event
- Communication board in the yard ($4247)
- Expenses for the school picnic
- Sensory bins.

Haven't paid for tarmac games/lines yet, even though approved last year – will happen probably this spring.

Staff appreciation luncheon totalled 576.82, but finance informed Mrs Wilson that council cannot pay for food for staff anymore, so that had to be paid for by the school instead.

Question: How much money is normally fundraised? With pizza we used to raise $20,000, but council is no longer running pizza as a fundraiser, as the school is doing that now because there are things the school would like to buy that council can't buy, so the money would be more useful there. It will be up to council to come up with ideas for if/how we want to fundraise.

Question: How does council do parent engagement? Many options – haven't done much in the last year. Playground was last big project council did.

Question: Is it worth trying to do another welcome event like last year? Yes, it had benefits for parents and many new parents have come to the school. This was an event in the gym before school to welcome any family that registered after the school year started so they could see the school, meet the office staff and get help signing up to School-Day.

Question: Is the money in the account meant to be spent in this specific school year? It can roll over, council can make decisions on how much to leave – some school councils try to spend most of it. Last year most expenses were small things, many of which were requests from the school, but council can also suggest things (like painting the new games on the tarmac).

Question: How do things like tarmac painting get done? Has to be done through school board vendors – applies to goods as well for things like data projectors. School was given ipads but none have cases. Council can spend on tech peripherals but not tech, so council will be asked for cases.

Principal's report:

- Students have settled in well, things are working well
    - Had the Terry Fox run, students had fun – good turnout from parents for the run too.
    - Trailblazer training for grades 5/6 has been done – Trailblazers are model walkers, who have been trained for safety on the street, they are there to be role models NOT to take care of the other kids
    - Trailblazers also get given other leadership roles – such as leading at Terry Fox run.
- School population up to 520. Very diverse – students from all over the world. A lot of the new registrants are families new to Canada
    - This is up from 460 3 years ago
    - Although this is rapid growth the school is handling it well, there do not seem to be problems from how quickly the school population has increased
- The school was given 0.6 FTE of MLL worker to support new students
    - Karen Wolfe is taking on the role rather than having a worker coming from the board, this is working very well
- EQAO results were sent home today
    - Students in grade 7 (at different school) may take longer, parents should contact Ms Humphries if it takes too long
- **Request**: Can the 576.80 that was supposed to be for the lunch last year (that the school had to pay for) be used for iPad cases? Motion Lauren, Second Tyler. Approved
    - Suggestion from parents – increase ask to cover enough for cases for all the iPads, not just the $576. Approved

Question: Do we do bake sales? We haven't because of allergy concerns (especially because some allergies are unusual) – better to do something prepackaged so that everyone knows what's in it.

Question: Laurelwood had internet safety presentation. Can we have a presentation by same person for senior students?

- That same presenter (Paul Davis) was here year before last, presented to students & did a session for parents. General support for the idea.
- School is lucky to not have a lot of phone issues. Kids do have phones here, but students are being reasonable – phones not out in classes or playgrounds, no social media issues
- Issues start in middle school so good to educate before it's relevant. Very busy presenter (busy nationally), so need to reach out now to be able to get him for this year.
- **Amy to reach out to Paul Davis to see about arranging internet safety presentation.**
- Cell phone policy is new from government: phones must be away unless being used in the classroom (not an actual change), but law now allows phones to be confiscated.
- Grade 6's are 1:1 tech devices, everyone else 2:1, so lots of chances to use tech without needing phone.

<u>Coat drive</u>:

- Doing an exchange of winter/fall outdoor gear.
- Anything that's winter outdoor gear. Splash pants, snow suits, boots, mittens, hats, etc. Must be in decent condition. Not for adult clothes.
- Will put out a reminder on School-Day. Will collect all week starting on Monday, items will be put in the gym on Thursday. (School will take care of putting bin out and taking it in). Everything will be laid out, people can take what they want, leftovers all get donated. (Items are sorted for quality before being put out – some students may rely on this so want it to be good.)
- Last year discussed shortening the event. Will keep the full hour to make sure people can get there – had people call the school afterwards asking about items.
- Christine and Stephanie to sort items before putting them out in the gym. Can get some grade 6 students to help lay things out.
- **Lauren and Hilory to put together announcement.**
- **Christine to search for last year's announcement**

If anyone has fundraising ideas, maybe from other schools, please bring it forward at meetings.

Question: should we do a survey for the parent community – how well does council represent the overall parent community? Has been a challenge to get people to connect with parent council. Council is overly skewed to French Immersion parents.

- Maite to put together a survey outline, bring it to the next meeting. (putting her e-mail out and will accept questions from rest of council)

Question: Had parent from previous council who would want to join but online. Should we switch to hybrid meetings? Enough people in council this year that isn't worth the hassle, especially since online people are often less able to participate in discussions as well.

Question: how many members expected beyond those who are here & Hilory?

- Have had interest from about 20 parents this year, although historically that is more than who actually show up.
- Minutes are posted on website, so available to entire school community.
- Last year had 4 members who showed up, but also had volunteers for the picnic and pizza day as needed.
- Council has a lot of things they can do, but if council is doing it then parents need to take the lead. (Is 4-6 approptiate for quorum)

Next meeting November 4

Adjourned: 18:53